BEFORE AND AFTER EXAMPLE

Example 1: Student Workshop Registration

Before — Excessive collection

A college workshop form requests the student's full name, personal email, phone number, home address, date of birth, government ID number and parents' occupation, even though the team only needs to register attendees and send event updates.

After — Minimized collection

Collect the student's name and one suitable contact method. Ask for additional information only if a documented need exists.

Why this is better: It reduces the amount of sensitive information stored and limits the potential impact of a data breach.

Example 2: Student Research Survey

Before — Excessive collection

A fictional study about library usage asks every participant for their name, student ID, exact home address, phone number and detailed family income, although the study only examines library visit frequency.

After — Minimized collection

Collect library visit frequency and only the demographic categories genuinely required by the research question. Use anonymous responses where feasible, or participant codes if follow-up is necessary.

Why this is better: The research question can still be answered without directly identifying participants unnecessarily. Any retained demographic information should be justified by the research design.

Example 3: Student Support Service

Before — Excessive collection

A fictional service offering general study-skills advice asks students to provide their full identity details, home address, medical history, family income and parents' contact details before allowing them to book a session.

After — Minimized collection

Ask for a preferred name, a suitable contact method and an available appointment time. Request additional sensitive information only if genuinely necessary for a specific support service, with appropriate safeguards.

Why this is better: Students can access ordinary study support without disclosing unrelated personal or sensitive details.